

To do:

1. Delete markdown section
2. Put in reflections for each week
3. Title for each week instead of week 1 - see below
4. Light mode and dark mode both
5. Need week 12 artifact from room- ask if a pic can be sent instead
6. ONLY 8 MAKES REQUIRED!!!! Dont need make 12 woohoo!

How I use AI:

AI was requested to be used throughout this course. Thus, I used models such as ChatGPT, Voyant text analysis, [Character.ai](#), and the copilot built into VS code to make this website as well as use in the makes as requested. AI was used under the guidelines required by the class, and was used responsibly to be part of the assignments to best analyze and understand the role of AI for an academic purpose. AI was not used to write assignments or answers I claim to be my own, as these were all written by me.

This class definitely changed parts of the way I look at this question. Being human in the age of AI includes the ideas of being aware of our humanity and what is special about it while harnessing the tools that are available to make things better. As humans, we are artists, thinkers, and makers, and there will always be a special place for human work that cannot be replicated by robots. One part of this would be the idea of lived experience. When a human lives through something or experiences something, it changes the way they write, paint, draw, think, and more. This is something that AI cannot replace. This is something that will always set humans apart from AI- the act of living as a sentient being. AI does not do this, no matter how hard it tries. While it is useful to use AI to work on stuff alongside us, I think and hope that humans will always have the control over the AI rather than the other way around. It really depends how we choose to use AI in the coming years. It has only become popular recently, but over time, it will become more or less popular, and we need to use it mindfully to do so. I hope that people are able to recognize that humans have something AI does not have, but that AI can be used thoughtfully and responsibly.

The Bender et al. reading about stochastic parrots is something I took into consideration during this class, because it talks about how AI does not come up with anything original, but rather takes input from the user (and the internet in general) to say anything. This is why AI must be used responsibly, because it is, at times, biased and flawed because of this. Thus, people must be careful using AI because it may have these opinions. Additionally, the paper by D'Ignazio and Klein about data feminism was part of my makes. For example, the network make about systems of power and AI were a connection to this piece because it shows the data we receive is not neutral, but rather biased. By including something, or not including it, in a data set, it is being skewed one way or another. This is something about AI that I had not thought about before reading this paper.

In conclusion, AI was used in a limited and responsible way throughout the making of this project.

Accessibility:

I used the Wave report accessible at wave.webaim.org to assess the accessibility of my website. I tried to improve accessibility by using a readable font of a decent size that is very similar to a standard computer text rather than using small or illegible font to promote readership. I also chose a simple color, pink, because it keeps things from being too staggering and is a color that is often seen by colorblind individuals. Additionally, I

Markdown guide??: delete

Sustainability:

Sustainability is an important consideration in terms of AI use. I tried to address sustainability throughout the course by writing about it for one of my infographics, which taught me that the average ChatGPT search uses 10 times the energy of an average Google search. Through learning this, I tried to reflect these morals through my usage of AI throughout the course. Thus, I tried to minimize my use of AI to an extent to minimize my carbon footprint while still completing the required materials.

Final reflection: This class definitely changed parts of the way I look at this question. Being human in the age of AI includes the ideas of being aware of our humanity and what is special about it while harnessing the tools that are available to make things better. As humans, we are artists, thinkers, and makers, and there will always be a special place for human work that cannot be replicated by robots. One part of this would be the idea of lived experience. When a human lives through something or experiences something, it changes the way they write, paint, draw, think, and more. This is something that AI cannot replace. This is something that will always set humans apart from AI- the act of living as a sentient being. AI does not do this, no matter how hard it tries. While it is useful to use AI to work on stuff alongside us, I think and hope that humans will always have the control over the AI rather than the other way around. It really depends how we choose to use AI in the coming years. It has only become popular recently, but over time, it will become more or less popular, and we need to use it mindfully to do so. I hope that people are able to recognize that humans have something AI does not have, but that AI can be used thoughtfully and responsibly.

REFLECTIONS

Reflect 1: What counts as “making” in the age of AI? What might be gained/lost when machines participate in making?

I find this question interesting. In the age of AI, machines can be used to be part of digital making rather than solely relying on effort, which is both good and bad. On the positive side, AI usage can speed up the project timeline, which is helpful for timed projects or people wanting to get something published. This is important because it makes the making process much faster. On the downside, however, AI can take away human jobs, especially in the world of writing, music, art, and research, which is not necessarily entirely beneficial to human life. It depends on how one views it. When machines participate in making, it allows for speedier publication of projects because of technological shortcuts rather than doing things individually, but the quality on new-age AI may also be a concern.

Reflect 2: Can AI help us define what it means to be human, or does it reduce us to patterns?

I personally think that AI cannot fully define what it means to be human on its own. Because much of it is run on an algorithm, it may only be based on that rather than branching out to make decisions. AI cannot think; this is something we know. If it cannot think for itself and is rather using other information, it cannot on its own tell us what it means to be human.

Reflect 3: What does “authenticity” mean when identity is co-constructed with AI?

Authenticity to me is similar to real, and less about originality. If something is authentic, it is true, it is undeniable and real. For example, a real photograph is authentic. But then, if something is a replication or an AI generation of something, it is not authentic because it is a simulation. Authentic identity is not co-constructed with AI, but rather, some simulation of an identity that is not authentic could be the only way to explain this.

Reflect 4: Is AI a collaborator, tool, or plagiarist in storytelling?

It really depends on how AI is used. I would say that AI can be seen as a plagiarist because it is taking other people's ideas from the internet because AI doesn't have a brain. At the same time, however, someone can theoretically feed AI their own ideas and then consider AI a tool to help work through their ideas without involving plagiarism. I worry about AI becoming an easier way of writing when I am a writer who wants to have a career in writing, so I hope that people don't use it as the only way to tell stories. I see AI as a collaborator or a tool rather than an original storyteller. Since everything AI

knows is information we have fed it, it cannot come up with anything truly original. It can tell stories, but in my opinion, not as well as human beings can.

Reflect 5: How does AI alter authorship and remix culture? Who owns AI-made art?

AI introduces an idea of authorship that has not existed before. Since it is made by computers, it is hard to know whether a human can exactly get credit for making it. I think that AI made art cannot be "owned" per se, by a human being, because you own what you are part of making. While AI art does take human input, I would never personally claim that art made by AI is mine, similarly to how I would never claim AI writing as my own. While remix culture is very popularly using AI, that does not mean that it is fair to say a human being did the work themselves.

Reflect 6: What do we gain/lose when machines "read" literature for us?

There are both benefits and drawbacks to using machines to read literature for us. Voyant tools, for example, is able to provide a detailed analysis of the number of times words are used throughout a story, as well as a word cloud of those, which can be helpful for certain projects. ChatGPT, and similar programs, can provide more meaning-based summaries, which is useful too. These are useful tools. At the same time, however, the hard work put into reading the text for yourself is also beneficial. The encoding of words enhances one's vocabulary, and reading can be part of this. Also, if someone abuses these tools by using them for quick summaries to use on homework regularly, for example, then they are not using them for their intended purpose and they may not choose to pay as much attention to the text as they should.

Reflect 7: How does AI reshape global geographies of power, labor, and environment?

AI reshapes global geographies of power, labor, and environment by emphasizing the headquarters areas being in one part of the world (in the Pacific Northwest or Silicon Valley, mostly) while the mining centers and data centers are in other parts of the world, such as the Midwest for data centers and African countries for mining centers. The people in the West Coast are buying up land in other parts of the country to run their sites from without including their own region, which is interesting because they use much of the environment in other places but don't ever consider their local areas in that same way. This links to the idea of not caring about the environmental impacts that are taking place because they may be far in geographical distance.

Reflect 8: Who is visible/invisible in AI networks? How does visualization reveal or obscure power?

By making a network, I got to reflect on this question a lot. I found that major corporations were the most visible in AI networks, such as ChatGPT and other competitors. On the contrary, some of the more invisible parts of AI networks are the people that use AI and where the information for its knowledge base has come from.

Reflect 9: What is creativity when AI can generate endlessly? Where is the human in generative work? What was your experience building the bot? Where you in control of the output?

"Creativity" is not a word I would assign to an AI bot, because it is rather recycling information in an algorithmic fashion. The human for me in the generative work I did (I did track d, characters) was to give the AI some ideas about what the character would be like, and the AI ran with it and came up with details about their life and chats that they would theoretically write. I think that these chats, though cool, were recycling information from previous similar stories rather than the AI "inventing" novel information. I was not very in control of the output of the AI outside of what I told it.

Reflect 10: How does AI change our relationship to play, rules, and narrative?

I think that AI has a huge role in algorithmic thinking, which changes the way we consider rules and narrative within a story. For example, AI uses past information to understand you and your decisions, which sorts you into its own game rather than only playing yours. It changes the way we look at rules therefore. It also changes the relationship to play by making new games and changing the way they work.

Reflect 11: Who does the invisible work of AI, and who profits from it?

The invisible work of AI is done by a variety of people, all of whom are at risk somehow. For example, content moderation is not done by robots, it is also done by humans. I did not know this prior to this unit. It made me really sad to hear that there are increased mental health problems in this group of people because of the potentially traumatic content they have to view. The people who are profiting from this are both the social media and AI companies as well as everyday people who view the algorithms, because they get to view non-triggering content.

Reflect 12: AI & Ecology Is AI sustainable? What ecological trade-offs are we willing to accept?

AI is not technically sustainable, at least not yet. It is possible to make it more sustainable by using forms of renewable energy to cool the plants and such, but at the moment, the amount of CO₂ that is used to perform certain essential actions to AI use is quite high, and substantially higher than a regular google search. This introduces a new consideration for technology use. If AI is powered by renewable energy sources and used responsibly, then there is a sustainable version of it.

Reflect 13: Do you imagine AI futures as utopian, dystopian, or in-between?

What do your visions reveal about us today?

It is interesting to think about AI futures because it is hard to know exactly where it will go. I sometimes tend to think of AI as producing a more dystopian future, because it could potentially take away jobs from people and lead to mass unemployment. At the same time, however, it could also be helpful because then people could be working less factory jobs or it could allow for people to spend more time with their families. I think it all depends on how we use it and how reliant we become on it.

Reflect 14: What does it mean to be human in the age of AI?

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Topics of each week:

Make 1 -> Reverse Engineering

Make 2 -> AI Selfie

Make 3 -> Make a Comic

Make 4 -> AI GIF

Make 5 -> Voyant “reads” *Pride and Prejudice*

Make 6 -> Google Maps of Data Centers

Make 7 -> Networks of Power

Make 8 -> Fairytale Characters

Make 9 -> Twine Story Game

Make 10 -> Manufacturing and Labor Infographic

Make 11 -> Carbon Footprint Visualization Infographic

Make 12 -> Eviction Statement from the Future